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## **Day 11 - Incident Detection & Alert Triage (Phishing Email)**

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### **Executive Summary**

Phishing alert investigated, confirmed true positive, host contained, and IOCs documented

### **Alert Description**

A phishing email alert was triggered for an email containing a suspicious attachment and external link, posing a potential threat of malware infection.

### **1. Investigation Process**

I began by reviewing the event details and collected key email metadata, including:

- Event time
- SMTP address
- Source email address
- Destination email address
- Email subject
- Email delivery status (delivered to recipient)

Using the gathered information, I navigated to the email security module and located the specific email. Upon examination, the email appeared suspicious and contained an attachment and an embedded link.

### **2. Evidence Analysis & Enrichment**

- The embedded link was extracted and analyzed using VirusTotal, where it was flagged as malicious.
- Email delivery logs confirmed the message was successfully delivered to the recipient
- Network and log data were examined to determine whether the malicious link was accessed or the attachment executed.

### **3. Log & Host Analysis**

- The recipient host's IP address was retrieved from the endpoint security module.
- Log management systems were queried using the host IP within the alert timeframe.
- Outbound network connections from the host were identified and analyzed.

- Log correlation confirmed that the user interacted with the malicious link.
- Further analysis revealed communication between the attachment and an external IP address.

#### **4. Indicators of Compromise (IOCs)**

- Malicious external IP address
- Command-and-Control (C2) communication identified
- Threat intelligence enrichment confirmed the IP as associated with AsyncRAT

#### **5. Severity Assessment**

- Impact : Potential system compromise and remote access
- Likelihood: High, based on confirmed user interaction and C2 communication
- Severity: HIGH

#### **6. Final Decision**

True Positive: Confirmed phishing attack with host compromise

#### **7. Response and Containment**

- The malicious email was removed from the recipient mailbox
- Endpoint containment actions were applied to prevent further communication
- Host processes, browser history, terminal activity, and network actions were reviewed to assess the scope of compromise